



Every Day Obedience

Premium practice worksheet

EVERY DAY OBEDIENCE - LESSON 08

Build self-control without conflict.

This worksheet helps owners teach the dog to disengage from items and release objects calmly through clear trades and reinforcement.

TRAINER NOTE

A clean trade works better than confrontation, especially for dogs who love objects.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the dog understands the basic picture of leaving an item alone and trading an item out on cue.

2 Practice plan

1

Teach leave it

Reward backing off or looking away from a low-value item.

2

Add the cue

Say the cue once your dog understands the pattern.

3

Teach drop it

Offer a better reward when your dog releases an item voluntarily.

4

Practice variety

Use different safe items only after the easy version is solid.



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Leave It and Drop It

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Low-value practice items
- ☐ High-value trade rewards
- ☐ Safe toys
- ☐ Leash if the dog tends to grab and run

Set up before you start

- ☐ Start with low-value items.
- ☐ Plan to trade, not grab.
- ☐ Keep reps brief and successful.

4 Leave it / drop it tracker

Date	Skill	Item	Reward	Response	Notes

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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Leave It and Drop It

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Starting with valuable or dangerous items.
- Pulling things out of the dog's mouth.
- Repeating the cue many times.
- Practicing when the dog is over-aroused.

If this happens, try this

- If your dog guards, stop and work with a qualified trainer.
- If your dog will not disengage, lower item value and upgrade the reward.
- If your dog grabs and runs, practice on leash with easier items.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ My dog understands that backing off earns a reward.
- ☐ I trade instead of confront.
- ☐ I know which objects are too hard right now.
- ☐ My dog can release easy items on cue.

HOMEWORK

Practice five easy leave-it reps and five easy drop-it trades across four days. Note which objects still need easier setup.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____